EDITORIAL STANDARD V1.0

The October Human Writing Standard

How AI writes, how people write, and the division of labour that gets press releases published rather than screened out.

October Communications
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Applies to
Releases, case studies, award entries, bylines

Enforced by
human-writing skill · Humanity Checker

SECTION ONE

What the test showed

Three samples through Pangram 4.0 on 12 October 2026. The detector was correct three times out of three.

AGENCY PROSE

100%

AI Generated

64 words, written by Claude. Correctly flagged.

HOLLAWAY F51 RELEASE

100%

Human Written

118 words, written by a person. Correctly cleared.

INDIEWALLS, HAND-EDITED

100%

AI Generated

68 words, Claude draft edited by hand. Still flagged.

The third result sets the policy. Hand-editing a Claude draft did not move it. The pattern lives in the structure of the writing, not in its word choice, so editing at sentence level leaves it exactly where it was.

There is no edit pass that converts AI prose into human prose

Rewrite four sentences in a 400-word release and the other 350 still carry the original fingerprint. Detectors score the whole document. The only lever available is where the prose originates, which is why this standard is about the workflow rather than about editing.

Why this matters beyond the score

Newsroom screening of AI-generated pitches is now routine. A release suspected of being machine generated reads as unverified, which makes it a liability to a journalist rather than a shortcut. The underlying fault is the same in both cases: nobody gathered the facts. Low specificity is what the detector reads and what gets a release binned.

SECTION TWO

How AI writes

Eight markers, all taken from the two flagged samples.

1 **Coordinate lists**

Three or four items with an Oxford comma. The loudest single marker.

> Three in 68 words: "hospitality, workplace, multifamily, and healthcare" · "its brand, its community, and its history" · "printing, framing, and sampling"

2 **Perfect parallelism**

Items in a list share grammatical form exactly. People break parallelism without noticing.

> "printing, framing, and sampling" — three gerunds in a row

3 **Every sentence resolves**

Each one is a complete, balanced proposition. Nothing trails off, nothing arrives as an afterthought, no clause turns up because the writer remembered something halfway through.

4 **Abstraction in place of detail**

Claims that describe nothing checkable. The Indiewalls extract held one concrete noun in 68 words.

> "approaches every project as a work of research"

5 **The closing flourish**

The final sentence lands an interpretation or a benefit rather than a fact.

> "...giving the art consultancy control over quality and lead time"

6 **Even information density**

Facts distributed smoothly across sentences. Human copy clumps three into one sentence and one into the next.

7 **No errors**

Grammatically immaculate from first word to last.

8 **Uniform register**

No shifts up or down in formality across the piece.

SECTION THREE

How humans write

Six markers, all from the Hollaway Studio F51 release that cleared.

1 **Seams and errors**

A comma between subject and verb. A dangling modifier that never says who is describing. Dropped articles.

> "Hollaway Studio's design for F51, features three skateparks" · "climbing wall... and boxing ring"

2 **Clumsy repetition**

A model varies these automatically. A person writing at pace does not.

> "ongoing programme" then "ongoing commitment" two sentences later

3 **Asymmetric emphasis**

Three intensifiers stacked in one clause while the rest of the copy sits flat.

> "placing community firmly at the very heart of its work"

4 **Knowledge that cannot be inferred**

Nobody works this out from context. Somebody knew it.

> "the tallest in the South East of England"

5 **Lumpy density**

Three facts in one sentence, one in the next.

6 **Lifted fragments**

Quoted phrases pulled in from outside the text and used as texture.

> "adrenaline building" · "immaculately crafted"

Do not manufacture markers 1 to 3. Deliberately roughened AI prose is a known category and detectors are trained on it. Markers 4 to 6 are the real ones, and they come from reporting rather than from style.

SECTION THREE · CONTINUED

The cleared sample, marked up

Hollaway Studio, F51 Folkestone. 118 words, cleared at 100% human.

Describing it as an 'adrenaline building', Hollaway Studio's design for F51, features three skateparks, climbing wall (the tallest in the South East of England), and boxing ring. The landmark building appears as an imposing concrete beacon shrouded in mesh rising out of the Folkestone Creative Quarter and has transformed the landscape of Folkestone both architecturally and for the local community. Part of a major ongoing programme to regenerate the seaside town, F51, reflects Hollaway Studio's ongoing commitment to placing community firmly at the very heart of its work. F51's design has already received a number of awards and was selected in The Guardian's best architecture of 2022 where it was described as 'immaculately crafted.'

Errors and seams Repetition and stacked emphasis Checkable facts

Read the green, not the red

The errors are a symptom. The green is the cause. A person who knew the project wrote this in one pass and left the seams showing, and the thing that makes it unmistakably human is that it carries fifteen checkable facts in 118 words. That density cannot be generated, imitated or edited in. It has to be gathered.

What a model would have produced

Clean grammar, varied synonyms, balanced sentences, and roughly three checkable facts. It would read better line by line and carry a fifth of the information.

What the journalist uses

The superlative, the location, the award, the Guardian line. Every element a sub-editor keeps is a fact somebody reported.

SECTION FOUR

The specificity count

The single most useful measurement, and the one to run before a release leaves the building.

Definition

Count every checkable item and divide by word count, times one hundred. A checkable item is a proper noun, a number, a date, a measurement, a currency figure, a named material, an award, a publication, or a direct quotation from a named source.

SAMPLE	ORIGIN	CHECKABLE	WORDS	PER 100 WORDS
Hollaway F51	Human	15	118	**12.7**
Indiewalls	Claude + edits	2	68	**2.9**
Agency prose	Claude	2	64	**3.1**

TARGET	MARGINAL	NOT READY
10+	**6–9**	**<6**
Ready to issue	Go back for more facts	The reporting has not been done

The count predicts coverage as well as it predicts a detector verdict. Journalists bin releases for vagueness, and vagueness is exactly what the detector reads. One piece of work fixes both problems, which is the reason this standard pays for itself regardless of whether anyone runs a checker.

Provenance: these counts are ours, from three samples, using the definition above. Treat them as a working benchmark until October has calibrated against its own corpus of twenty covered releases.

SECTION FIVE

The six-move skeleton

Reverse-engineered from the release that cleared. Five of the six moves are facts, which is why a model cannot fill them.

#	MOVE	HOW HOLLAWAY FILLED IT
1	**Hook phrase** lifted from a person	"adrenaline building"
2	**Scope** number, size, superlative	Three skateparks; the tallest climbing wall in the South East of England
3	**Material and siting** what it is, where it sits	Concrete beacon shrouded in mesh, rising out of the Folkestone Creative Quarter
4	**Impact** on the place or the user	Transformed the landscape, architecturally and for the local community
5	**Wider context** programme, portfolio, trend	Part of the seaside town regeneration programme
6	**Third-party proof** award, press, collaborator	Awards; The Guardian's best architecture of 2022; "immaculately crafted"

Claude fills

- The structure itself
- Which moves are still empty
- The questions that fill them
- Claims unsupported by a source

You fill

- Moves 1 through 6
- Every quote, verbatim
- Every number and measurement
- The sentences

SECTION SIX

The release fact sheet

What Claude hands you. Slots, never sentences.

RELEASE BRIEF	PROJECT · CLIENT · DATE
NEWS HOOK	
The hook	what changed, and when
THE SIX MOVES	
1 · Hook phrase	a line someone actually said
2 · Scope	number, size, first / largest
3 · Material	what it is made of, where it sits
4 · Impact	what changed, for whom
5 · Wider context	programme, portfolio, trend
6 · Third-party	award, publication, collaborator
QUOTES — VERBATIM, NAMED, WITH TITLES	
Client	name, job title
Designer	name, practice
Third party	name, organisation
FACT SHEET	
Dates	start, completion, opening
Dimensions	area, height, span, count
Materials	named, and why those
Cost	if disclosable
Exact location	street, town, postcode
Full credits	architect, contractor, structural, lighting
Photographer	name + required credit line
ASSETS	
Images	count, resolution, captions
Press contact	named human, direct line

Hard constraint. Claude never invents a fact, quote, name, measurement, date or award. An unknown slot stays empty. Fabricated specifics about a real client are a considerably worse failure than copy that reads AI-written.

SECTION SEVEN

The client interview

Forty minutes, twelve questions. Record it. The recording is the source of the quotes and, usually, the hook phrase.

01	What is the one thing about this project you tell people first?
02	What was the brief, in the client's own words?
03	What was the hardest problem, and how was it solved?
04	What is the number nobody expects? Size, span, count, duration.
05	Is anything here a first, a largest, or an only?
06	What materials, and why those?
07	Who else worked on it, and what did they contribute?
08	What changed for the people who use it?
09	What does this project belong to? A programme, a portfolio, a trend.
10	Has anyone external said anything about it? Award, press, peer.
11	What nearly went wrong?
12	What would you do differently?

The four that matter most

Questions 4, 5 and 10 produce the specificity. Question 1 usually produces the hook phrase. If the call runs short, these are the ones to protect.

Question 11 is the sleeper

What nearly went wrong produces the detail that makes a journalist pick up the phone. It rarely reaches the release, and it frequently reaches the feature.

SECTION EIGHT

The division of labour

Claude does everything except the prose.

STAGE	CLAUDE	YOU
Angle options	proposes	decides
Interview questions	writes	asks
Fact sheet	structures, flags gaps	fills
The prose	**does not write**	**writes or dictates**
Gap analysis	scores and highlights	acts on
Headlines	proposes ten	picks and rewrites
Pitch emails	drafts variants	personalises
Media list	builds and dedupes	approves
Follow-ups	schedules and drafts	sends

What it costs

STAGE	TIMEAUTOMATED
Client interview	30–40 minquestion set only
Fact and asset chase	45–60 minchecklist and chasing
Writing or dictation	**30–60 minno**
Approvals	variableyes

Writing is roughly a quarter of the job. Doing the prose by hand costs 30 to 45 minutes per release against a fully generated draft. What AI never did was the reporting; it let the reporting be skipped and produced plausible prose regardless, which is precisely why the releases were not landing.

The metric is cost per placement, not cost per release. A 45-minute release with no pickups has infinite cost per placement.

SECTION NINE

Writing the prose

Dictate it

Talk through the completed fact sheet into a voice note, then tidy the transcript. Speech produces uneven sentence length, abandoned clauses, repetition and afterthoughts with no effort at all. It is also faster than typing.

Leave the seams

Resist tidying every sentence to the same length. The instinct to smooth is the instinct that produces machine-shaped copy.

Quote people verbatim

Including the awkward phrasing. Never generate a quote, and never tidy a real one into fluency.

Lead with the fact, not the interpretation

"The tallest climbing wall in the South East of England" beats "a facility that redefines what a leisure centre is able to be."

The package

For architecture and design press the package usually decides it before the prose does.

01	**High-resolution images** with photographer credits and captions. Twelve properly credited images beats elegant writing with two low-resolution JPEGs.
02	**Full project credits:** architect, contractor, structural engineer, lighting, landscape, photographer.
03	**A fact sheet:** dates, dimensions, materials, costs where disclosable.
04	**Named people with job titles** saying something other than "delighted".
05	**A named human** who answers the phone.

ONE PAGE

Quick reference

THE AI FINGERPRINT

- Coordinate lists with Oxford commas
- Perfect parallelism in lists
- Every sentence resolves cleanly
- Abstraction over checkable detail
- Closing participial benefit clause
- Even information density
- No errors anywhere
- Uniform register throughout

THE HUMAN SIGNATURE

- Seams and small errors
- Clumsy repetition
- Asymmetric emphasis
- **Knowledge that cannot be inferred**
- **Lumpy information density**
- **Lifted quoted fragments**

The bold three are the real ones

BEFORE IT LEAVES THE BUILDING

- Specificity count 10+ per 100 words
- All six moves filled
- At least two named, verbatim quotes
- One superlative or hard number
- One third-party proof point
- Images, credits, captions attached
- A named human on the contact line

NEVER

- Rewrite copy to lower a detector score
- Manufacture errors or faux-rough phrasing
- Generate a quote
- Tidy a real quote into fluency
- Invent a number, date or award
- Let Claude write the sentences

Disclosure. Where a client asks, the honest description of this process is: researched, structured and fact-checked with AI assistance; written by October. That statement is true under this standard and false under a generate-then-edit workflow. Keeping it true is the point of the standard.

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